

- Git integration.
 - Inbuilt deployment wizard to help publish your Web application.
 - Integrated debugger—the most important component of an IDE, lets you set breakpoints, inspect variables and control execution.
 - Built-in terminal to access OS commands.
- Some might favour Eclipse. It's excellent, but I'll not mention it here, as it is not compatible with the GNU General Public License.

2. Komodo Edit

Komodo Edit is a free open source code editor. If you are not perfectly satisfied with the code editor you are currently using, you can switch to this. It is a cut-down version of the Komodo IDE, and is a complete solution to Web- and cloud-based projects. It uses the Mozilla code-base, along with Scintilla. This makes it different from other free code editors like jEdit and Notepad++. It also has a Firefox-type extension system for finding and installing add-ons. Its main features are:

- Supports Python, Perl, PHP, Ruby, HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, SQL, Tcl and XML.
- As usual, it is available for Linux, Windows and Mac OS X.
- Syntax highlighting, auto-completion and call tips.
- Komodo Edit 7 has added support for Node.js, CoffeeScript, LESS, SCSS, EJS and epjMojo.
- Website dedicated to Komodo colour schemes called Kolormodo.

Its built-in FTP client lets you access remotely hosted files without having to create a project or download an entire directory tree. If Firefox is your browser of choice, you would feel right at home with Komodo.

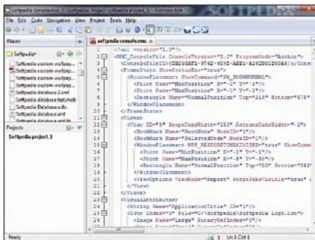


Figure 2: Komodo Edit

3. NetBeans

NetBeans is a free, open source IDE that started as an IDE for Java programming, but now you can create

professional desktop, enterprise, Web, and mobile applications with Java as well as C/C++, PHP, JavaScript, Groovy, and Ruby. It is a good IDE, but I mentioned it after Aptana and Komodo Edit, because it is not a fully dedicated Web development IDE. One feature that NetBeans is known for is its great debugging. You can make your code bug-free as fast as possible. Having started as a Java IDE, it has all the great features that the two IDEs mentioned in my list have.

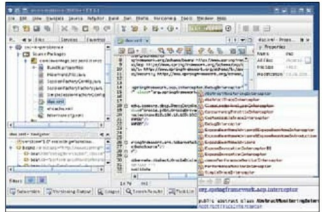


Figure 3: NetBeans

4. Drupal

Drupal is a very powerful open source CMS, just like WordPress and Joomla. It lacks high-quality themes like those available for the other two CMSs, but it is unique in its own way, and preferred for its good technical design and maintainability. I have used all three long enough to say that each is good in its own way. You can use a gel pen or a ball-point pen—yet it is hard to quantify which is better. But, if you are a beginner, I would say it is easy to handle Drupal, although installation may be a little bit more troublesome than WordPress. Drupal takes configuration management quite far, and allows the community to participate in a unique way. Its other advantages are:

- Getting static pages on a Drupal site is easier than in WordPress or Joomla.
- The Drupal module for social media integration is easier to work with than its counterparts for WordPress or Joomla.
- Ubercart, the e-commerce tool for Drupal, is excellent. You might have trouble working with the e-commerce tools for WordPress or Joomla (maybe some compatibility issues).
- Drupal, being old, has grown a lot and has a large community base, so you'll not be alone. Community support is very good, in my experience.

5. MySQL

MySQL is the most popular and powerful database and hardly needs introduction. It is open source and free. However, the enterprise version is not free, but compared to other enterprise solutions, it is still the best choice for its price and